

Sapphire**X1800GTO**

Radeon X1800GTO

✓

✓

VIVO *, RGB & S-Video
cables, Composite, aux
power connector

Driver CD

256/GDDR3

53

54

24

22

53.39

38.2

22

85.01

78.23

60.61

41.78

41.4

38.3

25.3

16.9

51.2

46.8

34.2

25.4

3384

7331

4

4.25

4.5

9.8

24.22

9.33

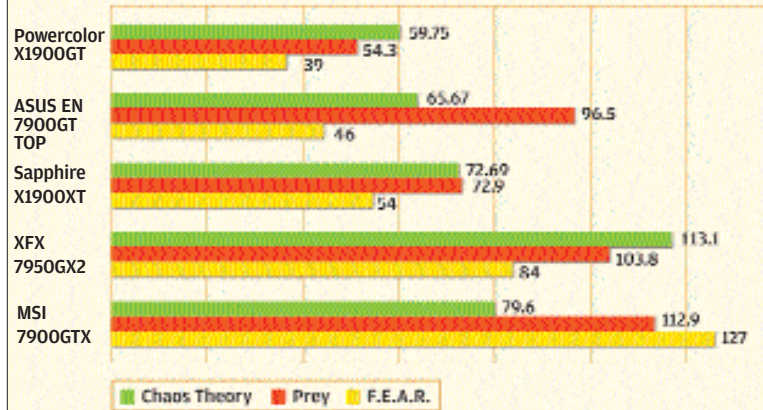
43.35

15,000



+ Decent VFM

- Lacks performance

High End Cards

How they did in the top looking games... NVIDIA VS ATI comparisons

NVIDIA-based card—the 7800GTX “golden sample” from Gainward. “Golden Sample” here means that these cards are supposedly created from hand-picked components, and tweaked carefully to give best performance. While we cannot verify the statement in any way, this card was factory-overclocked, and did perform extremely well and stably throughout all our tests.

We expected a lot from the X1900GT chipset, which is a slightly chipped-down version of the formidable “XT” version, with 36 pixel shader units, but this wasn’t to be. OpenGL has always been NVIDIA turf (NVIDIA cards perform better on nearly all OpenGL API-based games as compared to ATI), but this time the lead extends to DirectX territory, and the lesser of the high-end NVIDIA cores follow in the footsteps of the GX 2 and GTX based cards, with leading scores.

A surprise performer was the ATI 1800XL All-In-Wonder, simply because cards such as these usually concentrate on functionality rather than performance—the core wasn’t underclocked, as we’d initially expected. We had a pleasant surprise seeing this card just a touch behind both the X1900GT cards from MSI and Powercolor, and it manages to sneak ahead in a few of the tests as well—not bad at all!

Our Conclusion

Our Gold and Silver Best Buy awards go to the 7950 GX2-based heavyweights from XFX and Leadtek respectively. These cards really floored the rest when it came to raw performance, and

are the fastest things out there at the moment. If you are looking for an SLI setup or want to give the GX2s a wide berth, but still have the cash to burn, the MSI NX7900GTX will be a perfect companion for all your gaming needs. In fact, NVIDIA’s 7900GTX remains the fastest single-core gaming solution we’ve tested. This card can be paired with a twin for screaming SLI performance that will easily surpass a 7950 GX2. The 7950 GX 2 can also be used for a Quad SLI

setup, but we do not recommend sinking so much cash into such a gaming rig for two reasons: first, DirectX 10 is just round the corner, and second, Quad SLI is still in its infancy, and a lot of issues need to be ironed out.

If it’s the perfect balance between price and performance that you want, look for cards based on the 7900GT chipset. At Rs 18,500, the XFX 7900GT makes a sweet deal. With higher prices and lower performance scores, we think it’s time to bid the 7800GTX core-based cards goodbye.

For a gamer who wants something high-end, along with a lot of features, one of the best deals out there is the ATI X1800XL All-In-Wonder. For just Rs 14,500, you get a fast graphics card, along with a full-fledged, Windows Media Center-ready TV-Tuner with FM capabilities as well—an awesome deal!

MID-RANGE GPUS

A densely-populated segment, this category consisted of 20 cards.

The Middlemen
NVIDIA 7600GT, 7600GS
ATI X1600XT, X1600Pro, X850XT, X800XL

Features

NVIDIA’s mid-range flagship is now the 7600GT a.k.a. the G73, which is a smaller brother (by half approximately) of the G71 (7900 series). With 12 pixel pipelines, the 7600GT demolishes the part it was built to replace—the bestselling 6600GT—as far as performance goes; in fact it

Mid Range GPUs									
	NVIDIA				ATI				
Part Name	7600GT	7600GS	6800GS	6800XT	X1600XT	X1600pro	X850XT PE	X800XL	X800GTO
Manufacturing Process (nm)	90	90	110	110	90	90	110	110	110
Core Clock Speed (MHz)	560	400	425	350	600	500	540	400	400
(Manufacturer Reference Speeds)									
Onboard Memory (MB) / Type	128 / GDDR3	128 / GDDR2	256 / GDDR3	256 / GDDR3	256 / GDDR3	256 / GDDR2	256 / GDDR3	256 / GDDR3	128 or 256 / GDDR3
(Manufacturer reference)									
Memory Speed (MHz)	1400	800	1050	900	1380	800	1180	1000	980
(Manufacturer reference speeds)									
Memory bus width (bits)	128	128	256	256	128	128	256	256	256
Pixel Shader units	12	12	12	8	12	12	16	16	12
Vertex Shader units	5	5	5	4	8	8	6	6	6